

S.C.E.N.E

Stage #1 “S” = *SEARCH* the text: 10 classes / 1x/wk / 3hrs

1-10: Read the script 5 (five) times with no more than a 3 minute break in between each read

SILENTLY

anything that stands out to you i.e. *Actions, Names, Settings, Tasks, Descriptions etc. without any thoughts, judgments or choices. Write down*

JUST YOUR LINES ALOUD

without any thoughts, judgments or choices. Write down anything new, from the previous read, that

JUST THE OTHER CHARACTER(S) LINES ALOUD

without any thoughts, judgments or choices. Write down anything new, from the previous read, that stands out.

EVERY WORD ON THE PAGE ALOUD,

this means scene direction, slug lines, beats... EVERYTHING! No thoughts, judgments or choices. Write down anything new, from previous the read, that stands out.

EVERYTHING SILENTLY

no thoughts, judgments or choices. Do not need to write anything down during this step, just allow yourself to say and hear every word on the page.

3-6: Discover where the **BEGINNING**, **CLIMAX** and **END** of the scene are.

Note that the **BEGINNING** of your scene should take place prior to the MOMENT BEFORE! These are not the same thing so be mindful as you work.

The **CLIMAX** is where you sense a change in the dynamic within the scene. This could be a shift in your Character's mood, or energy, or the power exchange between your Character and any other Characters. Note that the Climax doesn't necessarily have to come in the middle of the scene.

The **END** of the scene does not always associate with the last word and or punctuation on the page. There is always "life" for your character after the dialogue or scripted action is over. Your Character could be finished with the scene before the last word and or punctuation on the page.

Ask yourself "What separates each phase?" Answer that question with as much SPECIFICITY as you can.

7&8: After reviewing the things that stuck out to you during the 5-Read portion and you have established your B.C.E. (Beginning, Climax and End)

Use that info to help identify what the **TONE** of the scene is from your Character's POV, i.e. HEAVY, LIGHT, ANXIOUS, NERVOUS, CALM etc.

What should the audience be feeling through your performance?

9: Define the **MISSION** (aka goal, objective, motivation) for your Character on each page of the scene.

"On page one my character NEEDS to do this, on page two my character NEEDS to achieve that" etc.

Like any soldier in battle, you never want to fail your mission. The only options are **LIFE** or **DEATH** so FIGHT FOR YOUR LIFE!

10: Condense all of the individual Missions from section 9 into one main overall Mission for the entire scene.

This will be your **LOGLINE** for the character i.e.

"In this movie, show, play etc. my character JANE/JOHN DOE is on a MISSION to _____."

This will be helpful when you are struggling with learning the text, simply chant your logline and you should be able to bring yourself back on track.

Stage #2 "C" = CREATE character: 17 classes / 1/wk / 3hrs

1-3: Create this questionnaire for your **CHARACTER**;

->Who am I in this moment?

->Where am I?

->When is it?

->What am I doing physically and mentally?

->Why am I there?

->How am I going to achieve my MISSION from STEP #1

4-6: Create the same questions chart for yourself as if **YOU** were in the same situation;

->Who would I be in this moment?

->Where am I?

->When is it?

->What would I be doing?

->Why would I be there?

->How would I achieve my character's MISSION from STEP # 1

7 & 8: Compare and contrast the two questionnaires to find the similarities and the differences that you and your character share/have.

9-15: What People, Places, Things, and Events from the **PAST** have shaped your Character in their **PRESENT** moment? DO NOT GUESS! Use your notes from Step #1 of T.A.P. to find specific and clear cut answers.

Fill in the uncertain answers by using the additional **CHARACTER QUESTIONS** you were given.

16 & 17: Assign a **SOUNDTRACK** to your Character. What type of music do they listen to in this scene(s)? Does the music motivate them to achieve their Mission? How does the music affect you as your Character.

C & E: Ask yourself the following questions when developing your Character's backstory and relationships:

- WHO is my character?
- WHERE is my character from i.e. where were they born?
- WHAT is my character's age/age range?
- WHAT is my character's physical condition?
- WHAT is my character's social class?
- WHAT is my character's economic status?
- WHAT is/are my character's religion/beliefs?
- WHY does my character speak the way that they do?

Do they have an accent or dialect or do they enunciate?
(There is a difference between Accent and Dialect)

- WHAT similarities do I as the Actor have with my Character?
- WHAT differences do I as the Actor have to my Character?
- WHAT are they wearing?
- WHY are they wearing it?
- WHERE did they get it from?
- WHAT do they do as a profession?
- WHY do they do their profession?
- WHEN did they start their profession?
- HOW long have they been in their profession?
- WHERE do they do their profession?

- C & E: -WHERE are they in this scene?
- WHY is this place/location of value, positive or negative, to my character?
- WHAT are my specific emotional, physical and mental connections to the place/location in the scene?
- WHO is my character with in the scene?
- WHY is that person(s) of value, positive or negative, to my character?
- WHAT are my specific emotional, physical and mental relationships to all people in the scene?
- WHAT literally happened to my character prior to the start of the scene?
- WHERE are they physically coming from at the start of the scene?
- WHERE is my character mentally at the start of the scene?
- WHERE is my character emotionally at the start of the scene?
- WHAT literally happens to my character in the scene?
- WHERE is my character mentally at the end of the scene?
- WHERE is my character emotionally at the end of the scene?
- WHERE are they physically going at the end of the scene?
- WHAT would happen if I weren't in the scene at this moment?
- WHAT does my character NEED to do in the scene?
- WHAT does my character WANT to do in the scene?
- WHAT objects are in the scene that are of value, positive or negative, to my character?
- WHAT are my specific emotional, physical and mental connections to all of the objects in the scene?

- C & E:
- WHAT is the mental barrier between the character and what they want?
 - WHAT is the emotional barrier between the character and what they want?
 - WHAT is the physical barrier between the character and what they want?
 - What are the sensory stimulants of the scene?
 - WHAT is the “soundtrack” to my character’s life aka piece of music would you pick to symbolize the character?
 - WHAT is the “soundtrack” to this scene?
 - WHAT do they want?
 - WHY do they want it?
 - WHAT is the LOGLINE
(aka “this is a scene about a man or woman... then insert all 5 Ws...”?)

-HOW AM I GOING TO ACCOMPLISH WHAT IT IS I **NEED** IN THIS SCENE?!

-HOW AM I GOING TO ACCOMPLISH WHAT IT IS I **WANT** IN THIS SCENE?!

*Assign **ACTION** words, **VERBS**, to your choices opposed to adjectives if possible.

Remember we are ACTors which means we are driven by ACTION.

*Also use **MOVEMENT** as much as possible when rehearsing your scene.

Interact with the other characters and the objects within the scene so that you can get a truthful feeling of what it is like to BE in that environment with those people.

Stage #3 “E” = ENGAGE the environment: 17 classes / 1/wk / 3 hrs

1-4: Engage your **ENVIRONMENTAL RELATIONSHIPS**. Use the following questions to create and engage your character’s relationship to their environment;

->What are the sounds? AUDITORY

->What does it look like? VISUAL

->How does it feel on your skin? TACTILE

->What kinds of smells are there? OLFACTORY

->How do those smells and sights affect your taste buds? GUSTATORY
(does it make you hungry, nauseous etc.)

This requires concentration and focus, so make sure that you are BREATHING and avoid all distractions!

Use the song that you have assigned to your Character in Stage 2 during your breathing exercise to help you focus.

Realize that our senses are connected to one another.

For example, something may LOOK like it would FEEL uncomfortable on your SKIN. Something may SMELL like it TASTES horribly.

5-10: Engage your **CHARACTER RELATIONSHIPS**. Use the following questions to create and engage your character's relationship to the other character(s) in the scene;

->Who are they to you?

->Where do you know each other from?

->How long have you known each other?

->What are they doing with and or to you?

->Why are they doing this or these things?

->How are you going to either assist or stop them?

->What is it that you WANT from them?

->What is it that you NEED from them?

11-13: Paint your environment by utilizing COLORS and ADJECTIVES!

What feelings come up when you hear the word BLUE or RED or YELLOW or AFRIAD or BORING or HUGE or STRANGE? Radiate these feelings through your speech and movements.

16 & 17: Once you have created your Character's world via these relationships based on the text, bring it to life using practical elements to help solidify it i.e. set up tables, chairs, bring out food or flowers, songs, noises etc.

Build your set!

Keep in mind this is for when you are not actually in the world i.e. on set, stage or location.

If you have access to these practical places then you should exercise this step in said places!

Work through the scene by getting it "on it's feet" but utilizing movement, the dialogue and your physical set up when you rehearse/work it.

Stage #4 "N" = NAVIGATE your emotions: 18 classes

- 1-10: How does your Character's Mental, Emotional and Physical state of being effect the R&B, RHYTHM & BEATS of the scene i.e. the pace of the conversation, the frequency of the physical doings or tasks, the attention to your partner, the length of the beats.

A good tool here can be your Soundtrack that you developed for your Character in Stage 2!

- 11-15: Physically work through the emotional choices you have made within the scene;

->How does your character move in these states of being?

->When do they move, if they move?

->Where do they move?

->Why do they move?

->What makes them move?

->Who or What are their movements directed towards?